



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Virtual School Standard Operating Procedures

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INTRODUCTION

The virtual school experience attempts to implement asynchronous and synchronous learning experiences for participants. These experiences will be done through live lecturing, video conferencing and messaging with multiple trainees/participants at once or individually self-paced. Assignments are graded and feedback is given via e-mails, messages and occasional video conferences. However, personal face-to-face meetings, discussions with trainers/facilitators concerning materials or interactions will be infrequent and in most cases non-existent.

The virtual classroom experience will have trainees/participants adjust to a style of learning that requires high levels of self-motivation and self-discipline. This is important as the freedom and flexibility in completing assignments on their own schedule to ensure full understanding of content and completion of assessments.

DEFINITION OF TERMS

Asynchronous: Sessions rostered for trainees/participants to engage in completion of learning activities that are individual or group based on their own time.

Synchronous: Rostered sessions in which facilitators and participants are in the same space at the same time

NORMS AND EXPECTATIONS OF TRAINEES/PARTICIPANTS

Attendance and Punctuality

It is expected that each trainee/participant attends all virtual activities. As such, each student should seek to maintain an attendance rate of 85% for each synchronous session and asynchronous activity of a course or programme. That means, each trainee/participant should be present except in cases where an excuse pertaining to a case being in the courts, exigence of duties, or medical and psychological issues is given. A request for an absence should be made to the respective course coordinator before synchronous sessions and if asynchronous tasks are to be affected, the respective trainer/facilitator should be notified and approval given for completion at a later date.

Similar to the attendance rate, each trainee/participant should seek to be early for each virtual activity (asynchronous and synchronous). In order to ensure that he or she is early, a trainee/participant should log in at least thirty (30) minutes prior to the start of each session.

Deportment

It is expected that the conduct of all trainees/participants will be governed by integrity, honesty, truth and the perpetual pursuit of excellence. He or she should demonstrate care and concern for everyone within the virtual space and show the highest levels of regard for self and others.

Grooming

As law enforcement personnel, it is important to demonstrate proper grooming as it relates to the Jamaica Constabulary Force Rules and Regulations (Book of Rules, p. 47-72 & Force Orders 3306 and 3307).

Speech

It is also expected that trainees/participants will always seek to expand both his and her spoken and written vocabulary as he or she conveys precision in sharing ideas. In addition, trainees/participants should endeavour to deploy his speech in contending for good rather than in defence of evil. In so doing, the JCF Public Interaction Policy should be used during question and answering, presentations and all other speaking activities so as to demonstrate regard for both external and internal customers.

THE LEARNING MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

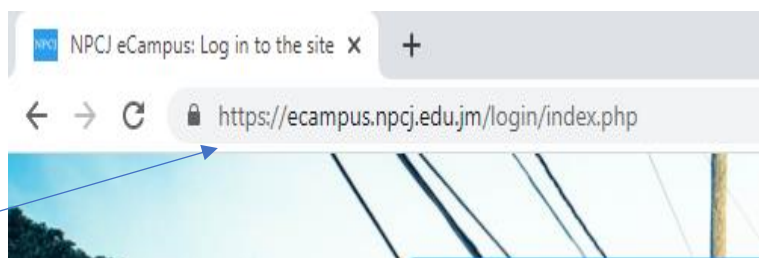
The NPCJ uses the MOODLE Learning Management System – E-campus. This system offers internal delivery of courses and programmes affiliated with the JCF.

This LMS is monitored and administrated internally by the NPCJ's Information and Technology Department. Course are uploaded for course/programme coordinators and the necessary training is coordinated and completed by its representatives.

ACCESSING THE NPCJ E-CAMPUS (Cheat Sheet)

STEP 1: FINDING THE E-CAMPUS

Go to your browser (Google, etc.) and the URL OR click on the link that you have received from the administrator

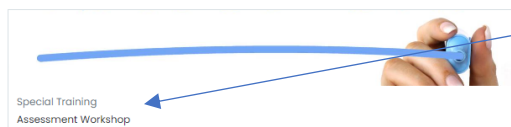
A screenshot of the login form on the NPCJ eCampus website. It includes a blue sidebar on the left. The main form area has the text 'Already have an account?' at the top. Below it are two input fields: 'Username / email' and 'Password'. There is a checkbox labeled 'Remember username'. A blue 'Log in' button is below the fields. Below the button are links for 'Forgotten your username or password?' and a 'Create new account' button.

STEP 2: LOGGING IN TO THE E-CAMPUS

Login using the username and password given by the administrator

NPCJ eCampus: Dashboard [Message](#)

essed courses



STEP 3: ACCESSING THE COURSE

Click here to access the course activities

GUIDELINES FOR TRAINERS/FACILITATORS

General Guidelines

1. Trainers/Facilitators are expected to be professionally attired for classes and are being advised to set up a suitable work area to conduct classes.
2. ALL classes MUST be recorded and posted under the “Recorded Sessions” Topic within 24 hours of lesson delivery on the NPCJ E-campus platform and remain there until the end of the course or programme.
3. Course outline, Announcements, Course Evaluations and the Modules for the respective courses are to be posted under separate topics on the platform.
4. Attendance MUST be taken for ALL classes using a virtual application and be saved for each trainee/participant, through a question or a virtual register.
5. Trainees/participants must have their cameras on for the duration of the class and this applies to trainers/facilitators as well.
6. There should be at least a 10-minute (per hour) break for topics or courses that are being facilitated for 3 hours or more.
7. For consecutively facilitated courses or programmes (where courses are delivered five days per week), trainees/participants should be given at least 2 -4 hours of ‘free’ or ‘rest’ time each week. During this period, trainees/participants are at liberty to decide how they can use this period. They are not required to log in to do any form of synchronous sessions.

Guidelines for Uploading of Course Content Trainers/Facilitators

1. All course outlines should be forwarded to ACP Training Branch for review and approval of competencies BEFORE uploading to the Learning Management System
2. The review of the courses will include vetting by the Curriculum Development and Coordination Unit (CDCU) alongside the Quality Control Mechanism Framework to ensure validity, currency, adaptability and credibility.
3. After this review, ACP Training Branch will consider approval for continuation of the course/programme and certification.

Pedagogical Practices for Online Delivery of Courses

Online delivery of courses require more agility on the part of the trainers/facilitators as it relates to engaging the trainees/participants to remain focused, energised and intrigued. Additionally, active learning should be the focus of classes where collaboration and adequate independent practice are facilitated. As such the pedagogical or teaching practices used should be done.

Engagement through Frequent Assessments

It is important for trainers/facilitators to gauge trainees/participants learning through creative and engaging means to ensure that the competencies expected from each trainee/participant in the operation of their policing duties and the objectives underpinning the course are accomplished. As such, the NPCJ wishes to highlight the importance of frequent formative assessments to be used to quickly identify and mitigate instances where trainees/participants may be struggling with the content being disseminated. Therefore, when training virtually, it is important for online tools such as Google Forms, Microsoft Forms, Survey Monkey, Poll Everywhere, Kahoot, Mentimeter be used as frequent formative assessments.

Multimedia Options for Assignments

It is important for assignments to involve trainees/participants in creating content with presentation and video recording tools, podcasts, blogs, etc. For example, an assignment with instructions for trainees/participants to be engaged in role-plays or presentations in the form of community meetings can be done with a video recording tool such as VidGrid.

Active Learning

The lecture model is important in delivering some topics based on the quality of its content; however, this model tends to be better appreciated with face-to-face classrooms. Consequently, it is expected that trainers/facilitators employ a mix of:

- a) Robust discussions
- b) Collaborative work
- c) Video and audio clips
- d) Simulation exercises
- e) Role-plays
- f) Precedence Case Reviews
- g) Individual work time (asynchronous sessions)

Collaboration

As much as possible, trainers/facilitators should strive for cooperation with other course trainers/facilitators, their respective Heads of Department and the CDCU to share best practices and, where necessary, assist in the creation of lessons and course materials to lessen the load of virtual school.